

Webcam Not Detected in Zoom — Troubleshooting Checklist

1. Check Physical Connection Unplug the webcam USB cable and plug it back into a different USB port on the computer. Avoid USB hubs — connect directly to the PC. Confirm the webcam's indicator light turns on.

2. Check Device Manager for Driver Issues Open **Device Manager** (Win + X → Device Manager) and expand **Imaging Devices** or **Cameras**. If the webcam appears with a yellow warning icon, right-click it and select **Update driver**. If it's missing entirely, click **Action** → **Scan for hardware changes**.

3. Review Windows Camera Privacy Settings Go to **Settings** → **Privacy** → **Camera** and ensure "Allow apps to access your camera" is toggled **On**. Also confirm that desktop apps (listed below the toggle) are permitted to use the camera.

4. Grant Zoom App Permission Still in **Settings** → **Privacy** → **Camera**, scroll down to "**Allow desktop apps to access your camera**" and make sure this is enabled. Then verify Zoom specifically isn't blocked by any third-party security or antivirus software.

5. Select the Correct Camera Inside Zoom Open Zoom → **Settings (gear icon)** → **Video**. In the **Camera** dropdown, manually select your external webcam by name. Zoom sometimes defaults to a built-in laptop camera or a previously used device.

6. Reinstall the Webcam Driver In Device Manager, right-click the webcam → **Uninstall device** (check "Delete the driver software" if prompted), then unplug and replug the webcam. Windows will attempt to reinstall the driver automatically. If that fails, download the latest driver from the webcam manufacturer's website.